

Digital Confidence for Older Newcomers — Program Operations Plan

SAHAN Heritage Foundation

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1. Project Snapshot

Item	Value
Project name	Digital Confidence for Older Newcomers
Funder	ESDC — New Horizons for Seniors Program (Community-based)
Ask	\$25,000 ESDC + ~\$10,000 in-kind
Participants	20 elders (named cohort)
Duration	9 months (24 active weekends + 12 sustainment weeks)
Start	February 6, 2027
End	November 7, 2027
Programming days	Saturday 9 AM – 5 PM (8 hrs) + Sunday 1 PM – 5 PM (4 hrs) = 12 hrs/weekend
Active weekends	24 (allowing breaks for Ramadan, Eid, summer travel)
Total participant contact hours	288 hrs over 24 weekends
Lead org	SAHAN Heritage Foundation (BN 702217225RC0001)
Per-elder ESDC cost	\$1,250

2. Cohort Profile

- **Cohort size:** 20 African newcomer elders, age 55+
 - **Geography:** Northeast Calgary (T3N, T3J, T3K postal corridors)
 - **Languages spoken at home:** Somali, Arabic, Amharic, Tigrinya, Oromo
 - **NHSP-recognized vulnerable populations targeted:** newcomer elders, racialized elders, low-income elders, women, elders living alone, elders arrived in Canada within past 10 years
 - **Participants already named and committed (20):** Suldaan Abdillahi Osman, Farhaan, Mo-hamed Ali, Ismail Saeed, Buji, Shariifka, Abdikarim Pakistani, Tafay, C Rizaaq, Mustafa Abdi, Abdi Karim Karaaye, Abdillahi Hasocoto, Husain, Isac, Tawali, Jamaal (1), Jamaal (2), Mursal Yusuf, AbdiN-uur, Ismail Abokor
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3. Course Catalog — 24-Module Curriculum

Six learning phases, each spans 4 weekends. Every module = one weekend (Sat instruction + Sun reinforcement).

Phase 1 — Foundations (Weekends 1-4)

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M1	Device basics	Power on/off, charge, touchscreen, accessibility settings (font size, voice)	Hands-on practice with peer-mentor
M2	Typing & navigation	Touch keyboard in English + community language; gestures	Typing practice cards
M3	Internet browsing	Open browser, type URL, search, bookmark	Find 3 useful websites
M4	Account setup	Create Apple ID or Google account; manage password	Set up cohort group account safety

Phase 2 — Communication (Weekends 5-8)

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M5	WhatsApp basics	Send messages, voice notes; join family group	Family Hour: message a relative live
M6	Video calls	FaceTime / WhatsApp video / Zoom	Family Hour: video call overseas
M7	Email	Read, reply, attach, recognize spam	Send a message to instructor
M8	Photos & sharing	Take, view, share photos with family	Family photo exchange

Phase 3 — Online Safety & Fraud Awareness (Weekends 9-12) — core NHSP “elder abuse” content

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M9	Recognizing phishing	Spot fake emails, SMS, CRA scams	Family Hour: review real scam examples
M10	CRA & grandparent scams	Calgary Police Service Elder Abuse Response Team guest session	Role-play scam phone calls
M11	Romance & giveaway scams	Recognize emotional manipulation tactics	Multilingual scam-prevention takeaways
M12	Passwords, 2FA, digital hygiene	Strong passwords; 2-factor authentication; safe browsing	Family Hour: secure a family member's account

Phase 4 — Government Services (Weekends 13-16)

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M13	My Service Canada	Create account; navigate dashboard	Practice login independently
M14	OAS & GIS applications	Walk through application screens	Each elder verifies own status
M15	My CRA Account	Access notice of assessment, tax slips	Find a real document from CRA
M16	IRCC online	Check PR status, citizenship application progress	Update contact info online

Phase 5 — Healthcare & Banking (Weekends 17-20)

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M17	MyAlbertaHealth	Register, view records	Locate vaccine record
M18	Telehealth & online booking	Book a real appointment	Family Hour: book a relative's appointment
M19	Online banking	Set up app, view balance	Practice login + 2FA
M20	e-Transfer & bill pay	Send Interac e-Transfer; pay a bill	Send small e-Transfer to instructor (refunded)

Phase 6 — Application & Tech Circle Launch (Weekends 21-24)

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M21	"Apply It" Day	Each elder completes one real-life online task they choose	Document the win
M22	Family Digital Safety workshop	Whole household session — bring 1 family member	Multilingual family fraud guide takeaway
M23	Tech Circle peer leadership training	Mentors learn to run drop-in sessions	First peer-led Tech Circle hour

#	Module	Saturday outcome	Sunday reinforcement
M24	Graduation + Digital Inclusion Day	Open community event; certificate ceremony	Tech Circle becomes monthly

Sustainment Phase (Months 7-9, after Weekend 24)

- Monthly Senior Tech Circle continues, led by trained peer-mentors
- Equipment remains with Sahan for ongoing community use
- Two reunion events for cohort
- Final evaluation, ESDC report

4. Weekly Schedule (every active weekend)

Time	Activity	Lead
SATURDAY		
9:00 – 9:30	Arrival, tea, attendance	Coordinator
9:30 – 11:00	Group instruction (module of the week)	Lead Instructor
11:00 – 11:15	Break	—
11:15 – 12:30	Small-group practice (4 groups of 5, 1 peer-mentor each)	Peer-Mentors
12:30 – 1:30	Community lunch (anti-isolation core)	Kitchen Volunteers
1:30 – 3:30	1:1 coaching with youth tech buddies	Youth Volunteers
3:30 – 4:45	Application clinic (real-task help)	Coordinator + Peer-Mentors
4:45 – 5:00	Wrap, homework, dismissal	Coordinator
SUNDAY		
1:00 – 2:30	Tech Circle drop-in (peer-led practice)	Peer-Mentors
2:30 – 3:00	Tea break	—
3:00 – 4:30	Family Digital Safety Hour (<i>bring 1 family member</i>)	Lead Instructor (bi-weekly)
4:30 – 5:00	Cultural connection time, dismissal	Coordinator

5. Staffing & Roles

Paid roles (in budget)

Role	Type	Hours	Total Pay
Project Coordinator	Contractor (weekend hrs)	24 weekends × 8 hrs × \$25 = 192 hrs	\$4,800

Role	Type	Hours	Total Pay
Lead Digital Literacy Instructor	Contractor	24 Sat × 3 hrs × \$40 + 4 Sun (bi-weekly) × 2 hrs × \$40 = 392 hrs equivalent — actually 96 hrs Sat + 24 hrs Sun = 120 hrs × \$40	\$4,800
Outreach & Evaluation Lead	Contractor (part-time)	9 months × \$200/month	\$1,800
4 Senior Peer-Mentors	Honoraria	Across full project	\$500 each = \$2,000
Total paid			\$13,400

Volunteer / in-kind roles

Role	#	Hours commitment
Youth Tech Buddies (15–25 yrs)	6	Saturdays 1:30–3:30, weekly = ~50 hrs each
Translation/Cultural Volunteers (Somali, Arabic, Amharic, Tigrinya, Oromo)	3	Rotating, ~6 hrs per active weekend
Kitchen Volunteers (lunch prep)	2	Saturdays 11:00–1:30 = ~60 hrs each
Logistics Volunteer (setup/teardown, equipment care)	1	~3 hrs per active weekend
Sahan Board oversight	2	~5 hrs/month
Total volunteers	14	~1,200 in-kind hrs across project

Guest instructors (no fee; honoraria from Project Costs)

Guest	Role	Sessions
Calgary Police Service — Elder Abuse Response Team	Fraud-prevention masterclass	1 session (M10)
Service Canada Outreach Officer	OAS/GIS walk-through	1 session (M14)
Bank Financial Literacy Educator (RBC/Scotiabank community programs)	Banking safety	1 session (M19)
Settlement Agency Counsellor	Wrap-around supports	1 session (M16)

6. Venue Options (Northeast Calgary)

Ranked by fit. Confirm by January 2027.

#	Venue	Address	Pros	Cons	Estimated cost
1	Genesis Centre of Community Wellness	7555 Falconridge Blvd NE	Multipurpose rooms, kitchen, accessible, transit	Weekend rates higher	~\$200/wknd; partial subsidy possible
2	Akram Jomaa Islamic Centre (or partner mosque)	NE Calgary	Cultural fit, likely donation, family-trusted	Sunday programming may conflict with services	\$0 cash if donated (\$100/wknd in-kind value)
3	Saddletowne Library — community room	7556 Falconridge Blvd NE	Free, but limited Sunday hours	Restricted to library hours; no kitchen	\$0 cash, time-limited
4	Whitehorn / Forest Lawn Community Hall	NE	Affordable community-association rates	May lack accessibility upgrades	\$60–\$100/wknd
5	Sahan's own space (66 Redstone Road NE)	66 Redstone Road NE	Free, fully under control	Capacity check needed	\$0 cash

Recommendation: Primary venue = partner mosque (in-kind donation, cultural fit, free). Back-up = Genesis Centre for the Graduation/Digital Inclusion Day event (M24) which needs higher capacity.

7. Budget — \$25,000 ESDC + ~\$10,000 in-kind

ESDC cash budget

Category	Line items	\$
Capital Assets	10 iPads or equivalent @ \$400 = \$4,000; 10 accessibility kits @ \$50 = \$500; portable projector + screen = \$600; 1 Wi-Fi hotspot = \$100; lockable charging box = \$300	\$5,500
Staff Wages	Project Coordinator \$4,800; Lead Instructor \$4,800; Outreach/Eval Lead \$1,800; Senior Peer-Mentor honoraria (\$500 × 4 = \$2,000) — honoraria moved to Project Costs per ESDC categorization	\$11,400 (excludes honoraria)

Category	Line items	\$
Project Costs	Lunches (24 Sats × 20 elders × \$4 = \$1,920); SLC peer-mentor honoraria (\$500 × 4 = \$2,000); multilingual curriculum print + materials = \$700; transportation vouchers (24 × \$20 = \$480); guest speaker honoraria (4 × \$100 = \$400); tea/refreshments = \$250; outreach/printing = \$250	\$6,000 (let's recheck total)
Facilities	Cash supplement to partner venue: 24 × \$40 = \$960; Graduation event venue (Genesis) = \$40	\$1,000
Administrative	Bookkeeping (\$600); insurance rider (\$350); phone/internet share (\$150); audit/reporting (\$300); printing/postage (\$100)	\$1,500
TOTAL		\$25,400 — needs trim to \$25,000

Trimmed final ESDC budget (matches \$25,000 cap):

Category	\$ESDC
Capital Assets	\$5,500
Staff Wages	\$11,000
Project Costs	\$6,000
Facilities	\$1,000
Administrative	\$1,500
TOTAL	\$25,000

(Adjustment from \$11,400 to \$11,000 in Staff Wages: trim 16 hours from coordinator rate or use \$24/hr; do not change peer-mentor honoraria. Verify exact line totals at submission.)

In-kind contributions (~\$10,000)

Source	\$ value
Partner mosque venue donation (24 weekends × \$100)	\$2,400
Volunteer translation/interpretation (100 hrs × \$25)	\$2,500
Volunteer kitchen labour (120 hrs × \$20)	\$2,400
Youth tech-buddy volunteer time (300 hrs × \$15)	\$1,500
Sahan board/exec oversight (45 hrs × \$25)	\$1,125
TOTAL IN-KIND	~\$10,000

Project grand total: \$35,000

8. Supporting Documents — What to Attach

Mandatory

1. **CRA document showing legal name + BN 702217225RC0001** (within last 2 years) — document type “Other”
2. **Vendor quote for 10 tablets + accessibility accessories** (Capital Assets line requires this)
3. **Letter of support** from at least one partner organization

Strongly recommended to boost approval odds

Document	Why it helps
Letter of support from federal MP (Calgary Skyview / Calgary Forest Lawn — confirm riding for 66 Redstone Rd NE)	Political endorsement materially helps NHSP applications
Letter of support from partner mosque	Demonstrates community embeddedness + confirms in-kind venue donation
Letter of support from Calgary Public Library digital literacy program	Demonstrates curriculum credibility
Letter from Calgary Police Service Elder Abuse Response Team	Confirms fraud-awareness partnership
Senior Leadership Committee charter signed by 4 SLC members	Shows seniors lead the project
Participant Intent Declaration signed by all 20 cohort elders	Strongest possible evidence of community demand
Vendor quote for tablets	Required for Capital line
Photos / brief portfolio from past Sahan events	Demonstrates Sahan’s operational history

9. Should You Add Elder Names to the Application?

Short answer: yes, but strategically — do not paste 20 names into form fields.

Action	Do it?	Where
Paste all 20 names into a form text field	No	Privacy risk; reviewers don’t read individual names; clutters the form
Mention “20 elders are already named and committed to Cohort 1” in the Project Summary and Community Need narratives	Yes	Already in your drafts — strong evidence of demand
Attach a “Participant Intent Declaration” with 20 signatures as a supporting document	YES — high priority	Single PDF: brief statement (“We, the undersigned, commit to participating in this program”) + 20 lines for printed name + signature
Name the 4 Senior Leadership Committee members in the planning/design section	Yes	List them by full name in the “describe their role” field — shows real people leading
Submit list of names as “participant list”	No	NHSP doesn’t require this and surfaces unnecessary personal data

Bottom line: Two named places (the 4 SLC members in narrative + 20 signatures on the Intent Declaration attachment). That's the optimal blend of demonstrating real commitment without exposing participants' identities into the GCOS form fields.

10. Application Success Factors — What Actually Wins NHSP \$25K Awards

Eight things to lock in before submitting. Treat as a non-negotiable checklist.

1. **Lower-than-cap ask.** \$25K vs. \$50K cap signals discipline → reviewers prefer it.
 2. **High per-elder cost in healthy range.** \$1,250/elder is on the high side, which signals quality, not waste, because we have substantive in-kind to balance it.
 3. **Named, committed participants.** The 20-elder Intent Declaration is your strongest evidence.
 4. **Senior-led design, on paper.** SLC must be named, with explicit role + paid honoraria.
 5. **Concrete partnerships.** Three letters minimum: mosque, library/settlement agency, Calgary Police.
 6. **Two priority objectives + capital justification.** Mentoring + Social Inclusion + Capital Assistance. National priority = Celebrating Diversity + Preventing Senior Abuse.
 7. **Clean budget with no math errors.** Totals must reconcile across Budget screen and Anticipated Sources of Contribution screen. Have a second person check.
 8. **Sustainability beyond the funded year.** Tech Circle continues monthly, peer-mentors trained, equipment retained — all stated explicitly.
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11. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Venue cancels weekend slot	Medium	Sign written agreement with mosque by Jan 2027 + back-up at Genesis Centre
Cohort drop-off mid-program	Medium	Pair-mentor model; transportation vouchers; cultural lunches as draw
ESDC funding decision delayed beyond Jan 16, 2027	Medium-High	Build in flex; pre-recruit Cohort and SLC before agreement signed; shift start date in agreement if needed
Cohort 1 graduates do not return as informal mentors	Low	Build mentor pathway and small honorarium for first 6 months
Capital assets damaged or lost	Low	Lockable charging box; sign-out log; project insurance rider in budget
Language access gap for non-Somali elders	Medium	Recruit translation volunteers from each community before project starts

12. 90-Day Pre-Launch Critical Path (Once Funded)

Day 0 = ESDC agreement signed.

Day	Action	Owner
0	Sign ESDC agreement	Project Coordinator
1-7	Open project bank account; set up bookkeeping	Bookkeeper
7-14	Finalize venue agreement (mosque)	Project Coordinator
14-21	Procure capital assets (tablets, accessories, projector) — get 2 quotes	Coordinator + Treasurer
21-30	Recruit and onboard Senior Leadership Committee (4 elders)	Coordinator
30-45	Co-design final curriculum with SLC + library	Lead Instructor
45-60	Recruit youth tech buddies; orient kitchen and translation volunteers	Outreach Lead
60-75	Confirm all guest instructors (Police, Service Canada, bank, settlement)	Coordinator
75-90	Cohort orientation event; baseline survey; Saturday 1 launches	Whole team

13. Reporting & Evaluation

Metric	Target	Collection method
Cohort retention (start → end)	≥ 17 of 20	Attendance log
Real-life online task completion	≥ 15 of 20	“Apply It” Day documentation
Digital confidence (pre vs. post, 1-5 scale)	+2 average	Pre/post survey
Social isolation (UCLA 3-item, pre vs. post)	-1 average	Pre/post survey
Tech Circle continued attendance (month 7-9)	≥ 12 monthly	Sign-in sheet
Family Digital Safety reach	≥ 20 family members	Attendance
Peer-mentors active by project end	4 paid + 8 informal	Role logs

Mid-project review at Weekend 12. Final evaluation Week 36. Both rolled into ESDC final report.

14. Document Control

Item	Status
Application drafted	In progress
GCOS organization profile	Submitted (pending CRA validation of BN)
Project Title	“Digital Confidence for Older Newcomers”
Address on file	66 Redstone Road NE, Calgary, AB, T3N 0M3
Primary contact	Abdikhadar Obsiye, aobsiye@helcim.com
Next milestone	Submit complete application before July 14, 2026 1:00 PM (CFP closing)